Use whatever proportion of carrots and Jerusalem artichokes you have, adding up to 1lb 9oz (700g) in total. The carrots enhance the color and sweetness of the soup.

jerusalem artichoke soup with saffron and thyme

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 35–45 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

2 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil, plus extra to garnish
2 medium onions, chopped
3 garlic cloves, chopped
12oz (350g) Jerusalem artichokes, scrubbed and coarsely chopped
12oz (350g) carrots, scrubbed and coarsely chopped
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
1.2 quarts (1.2 liters) hot vegetable stock
1 tbsp fresh thyme leaves or 1½ tsp dried thyme
large pinch (about 30 strands) of saffron
juice of ½ lemon

1 Heat the oil in a large pan over medium heat, add the onions, and cook for 5–10 minutes or until soft and translucent. Add the garlic and cook for another 30 seconds or until fragrant. Stir in the artichokes, carrots, and a little salt, then cover with a lid and sweat, stirring frequently, for 10–15 minutes or until the vegetables are softened.

2 Add the stock, thyme, and saffron, bring to a boil, then lower the heat to a simmer and cook for 20 minutes or until the vegetables are thoroughly soft. Cool briefly, then process until smooth in a blender. Stir in the lemon juice and season to taste with salt and freshly ground black pepper. Serve in warm bowls, with a drizzle of olive oil on top.